TOP STOCK BROKING APPS

Groww Invest Tech	Zerodha Broking	Angel One	Upstox Securities	INDmoney
13.02 MN	7.96 MN	7.65 MN	2.79 MN	0.84 MN

Above figures denote number of active clients

TOP FINFLUENCERS



RACHANA RANADE
5.3 MN / 1.1 MN



SHARAN HEGDE
3.5 MN / 2.8 MN



ANANT LADHA
3 MN / 1.1 MN



SAKCHI JAIN
.71 MN / 1.7 MN



NEHA NAGAR
.39 MN / 2 MN

YouTube Subscribers
Instagram Followers

breed of financial educators: finfluencers. Where financial advice was once limited to English-language media and SEBI-registered advisors, today's investors turn to Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts, Telegram groups and WhatsApp forwards.

On YouTube, Rachana Ranade's classroom-style breakdowns and Sharan Hegde's humour-laced analogies have drawn millions of views. Instagram creators like Sakchi Jain engage young, regional-language audiences with punchy explainers, while influencers such as Anant Ladha and Neha Nagar combine financial expertise with digital fluency to build trust across platforms. For many in Tier 2 and 3 cities—where traditional financial literacy remains low—these creators, with their bite-sized, relatable content, have become the face of market wisdom, shaping how people approach SIPs, IPOs or mutual funds.

Brokerage firms have leaned into the trend. Groww actively partners with regional-language influencers; Zerodha's Varsity platform offers free, structured courses. In doing so, they're bridging the information gap left by jargon-heavy PDFs and inaccessible AGM calls.

But this democratisation has also come with a downside. Not all influencers are qualified. Some push unverified tips, dubious penny stocks or pump-and-dump schemes. At the same time, a newer, more insidious threat has emerged: AI-generated deepfakes. Fake videos of NSE CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan, his BSE counterpart Sundararaman Ramamurthy and even former RBI Governor Shaktikanta Das touting too-good-to-be-true dubious schemes have hit gullible investors. As India's retail investing class grows, trust, transparency and digital literacy are becoming as crucial as financial acumen. ■

—Anilesh S. Mahajan

investor," notes Nilesh Lodaya, Chief of Business Development & New Projects, CDSL. "Their remarkable ability to adapt, swiftly embrace dematerialisation, eKYC, online account opening and digital trading platforms has transformed India's securities markets."

Even traditional banking players and new-age wealth managers have entered the fray, launching mobile-first investment products and AI-driven robo-advisory services targeted at younger investors. The line between saving and investing is increasingly blurring for salaried millennials and Gen Z professionals. According to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and Boston Consulting Group data, mobile-led investment accounts offered by banks grew 4.7 times between FY20 and FY24, with ICICI Direct Neo, HDFC Sky and SBI Securities together capturing over 18 million active users under the age of 35.

"The future of wealth is frictionless and digital," says Charan Singh, former chairman of Punjab & Sind Bank. "For the new generation, a mutual fund SIP is no longer a banker's paper form, but a 30-second flow on a mobile screen." A senior HDFC Bank executive echoes that: "We are seeing the salary account itself become a gateway to investing, with bundled wallets, auto-invest features and UPI-based SIPs driving volumes that were once unthinkable."

The optimistic sentiment was reinforced by a string of high-profile initial public offerings (IPOs) between 2020 and 2023, including marquee listings in tech, finance and consumer sectors. These IPOs didn't just unlock capital for companies, they also brought in a wave of first-time investors, many of whom remained active in the markets long after the listing day buzz faded.